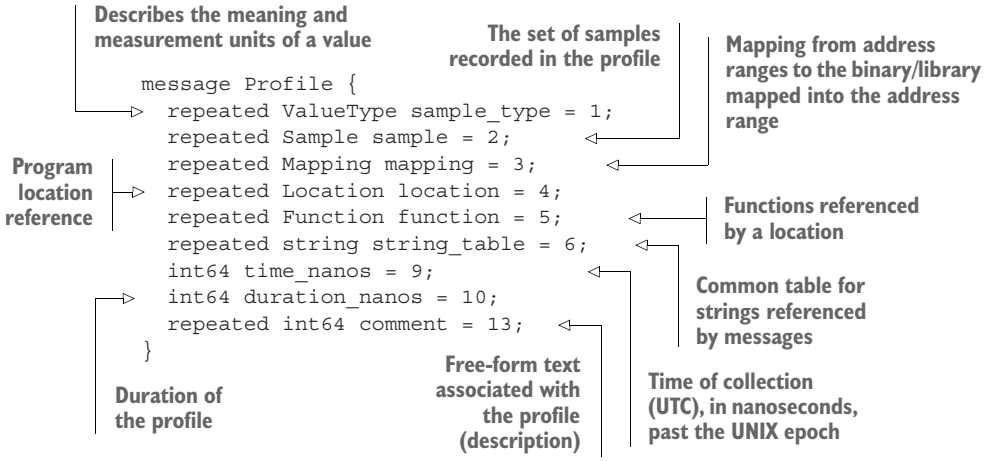
9.1.2 Common technologies

There are three technologies that you will find in many, if not all, continuous profiling tools. Before we get to the tooling itself, let us quickly discuss these common technologies.

PPROF

We already saw `pprof` in action in the introduction of this section, but let's zoom out a bit. `pprof` (https://github.com/google/pprof) is a visualization and analysis tool for profiling data, developed by Google. It is well integrated into Go, but more importantly for our discussion, it defines a data format to represent profiles. This `pprof` format is based on a protocol buffers (protobuf) schema (https://protobuf.dev/) defined in profile.proto (see the following site for the fully documented protobuf file and the following text for a description of the most important parts: https://github.com/google/pprof/blob/main/proto/profile.proto):



The `Profile` message uses several other messages (again, edited to the most important parts; see profile.proto for the details), including the following:

